Transition Words & Phrases

Concept

Transitions show the relationship between ideas. Choose the relationship first, then choose the wording.

Bridge

Connects sentences or paragraphs so the reader can follow your thinking.

Logic first

Addition, contrast, sequence and cause are different relationships. A transition cannot repair a missing logical connection.

Punctuation

Use a comma after an opening transition: However, … . Between complete sentences, use a period or semicolon before however.

Reference bank

The following lists preserve the handout categories. Entries are options, not interchangeable synonyms; some need surrounding words.

Example 1 | original model

Choose a transition: The first plan is cheaper. The second plan lasts longer.

Solution / why it works

1. Relationship: contrast between cost and durability.
2. Revision: The first plan is cheaper; however, the second lasts longer.
3. Why it works: however signals the trade-off; the semicolon separates complete clauses.

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Location / Space

above	beside	next to
across	between	of
adjacent	beyond	off
after	by	on top of
against	down	onto
ahead	from	opposite
along	in back of	outside
among	in front of	out of sight
around	including	over
at	inside	surrounding
at a distance	into	through
away from	in the background	throughout
before	in the foreground	towards
behind	near	under
below	nearby	upon
beneath	nearer	within

Word bank | Time / Sequence

about	at once	eventually
after	at the same time	finally
afterward	at the time	first
and then	at this point	first of all
as evidence	before	followed by
as soon as	before long	for a minute
at first	concurrently	for instance
at last	during	for now
at least	earlier	formerly

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Time / Sequence (continued)

generally
immediately
in fact
in the meantime
in time
in turn
last
later
meanwhile
next
next week
once
ordinarily
previously
rarely
second
simultaneously
since
soon
subsequently
then
thereafter
third
till
to begin
to begin with
today
tomorrow
until
usually
when
while
yesterday

Word bank | Cause and Effect

accordingly
as a result of
because
because of
brought about
caused by
consequently
due to
for the reason
if...then
in effect
is responsible for
leads to
otherwise
since
so
so that
therefore
when
whenever

Word bank | Compare and Contrast

a variation
again
alike
also
although
an alternative
analogous to
another view
as
as opposed to
as seen
as well as
balanced against
both
but

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Compare and Contrast (continued)

by comparison
compared to
contrasted with
contrasting
conversely
despite
differing from
discrepancy
disparity
distinction
equally
evaluate
even though
however
in a different way
in a similar way
in contrast
in like fashion
in like manner
in spite of
in the same way
like
likewise
match
nevertheless
nonetheless
nor can one ignore
on the contrary
on the other hand
one and the same
placed side by side
rather than
regardless
similar to
similarly
then again
though
uniquely
unlike
weigh against
where
whereas
whether or not
while
yet

Word bank | Introducing an Idea or Point

according to
accordingly
additionally
again
also
although
an added point
an alternative
and then
another
as a matter of fact
as much as possible
as well as
at the same time
besides
but
case in point
consequently
equally important
essentially
first
for example
for instance
for the purpose of
further
furthermore
ideally
in addition
in any event
in fact
in particular
in reality
in short

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Introducing an Idea or Point (continued)

in this case
indeed
likewise
markedly
more importantly
moreover
must
namely
nevertheless
next
officially
on the contrary
on the other hand
one also can say
one could also add
one more
otherwise
particularly
primarily
proof of this
second
similarly
such
such as
technically
that is
then
then too
theoretically
therefore
third
this can be seen
thus
to be sure
to demonstrate
to demonstrate this
to illustrate
to this extent
to this extreme
to reveal
truly
undoubtedly
what's more
when
where
whereas
without doubt

Word bank | Summary or Conclusion

accordingly
after all
all in all
and so
as a result
as a result of
as noted
as shown
at last
briefly
concludes with
concluding
consequently
finally
to summarize
to this end
today
ultimately
without a doubt
for these reasons
for this reason
hence
in a word
in all
in brief
in conclusion
in other words
in short
in sum
in summary

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Summary or Conclusion (continued)

in the end
in the final analysis
in view of that
in total
last
nevertheless
now
on the whole
on whole
summing up
summarizing
therefore
thus
to conclude
to sum up
totally

Transition Words & Phrases

Practice | your turn

1. Join: The library closed. We studied at home. Show cause and effect.

2. Join: One character seeks praise. The other avoids attention. Show contrast.

3. Write a bridge from a paragraph about cost to a paragraph about reliability.

Transition Words & Phrases

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

The library closed, so we studied at home.

2

One character seeks praise, whereas the other avoids attention.

3

Possible bridge: Cost matters at first, but reliability determines whether the purchase remains useful.

Source & editing note

27 - Transition Words & Phrases Reference List to Use in Writing - Over 300.pdf | 2 supplied pages.

Source credited to Simply Novel in the supplied PDF. Concepts reorganized and condensed; repeated templates consolidated. Examples, practice and sample answers here are original additions, not copied student work.

Exact repeated list entries were consolidated and obvious extraction/spelling errors repaired. Alternatives may differ in meaning, grammar or tone.